



Bio-chips for neural networks
Building an artificial brain with 86 billion physical neurons might be 1000x efficient
<https://digit.in/apr22-27>



Birth control for men
Human trials for a birth control pill for men could start sometime this year.
<https://digit.in/apr22-28>

Sony HT-A9

Immersive virtual surround sound



BUILD75
FEATURES.....90
PERFORMANCE.....85
VALUE.....75

Price
₹1,69,990

With the gradual rise of streaming services, home theatres in a box along with soundbars started getting prominence. Both the home theatre in a box and soundbar need to place speakers at specific positions for you to get the best surround sound. But what if you didn't need to place the speakers symmetrically? Or the speakers need not be at the same height or equidistant from one another? That's the problem the Sony HT-A9 aims to solve and let's see how it does!

BUILD AND DESIGN

In the box, you get the four cylindrical speakers along with a power cable for each. There is also a control box that connects to the TV. There's also an HDMI cable in the box. In the subwoofer box, we get just the subwoofer and the power cable.

Each speaker is as tall and as wide as an Xbox Series X and it is only slightly shorter than the PS5. They are heavy and well built. While the speakers have a cylindrical design. Each speaker has an off-white colour and the front-facing driver and top driver are covered with a grill.

SETTING UP

Setting up the Sony HT-A9 is a unique experience. Each of the 4 speakers don't need to be placed symmetrically. They can be placed based on the layout of your room. All you need to ensure is that the speaker point in your direction – the front speaker's point in front and

the surround speakers face you.

Once placed and connected to a power outlet, connect the control box to your TV via the HDMI cable. All the speakers and the subwoofer have a red light that turns green once the control box is on. On your TV switch to the HDMI eARC source.

Follow the onscreen instructions which will guide you to connect to Wi-Fi and also calibrate the system.

CONNECTIVITY OPTIONS

When it comes to connectivity options, the Sony HT-A9 has an HDMI port for eARC and one HDMI pass-through port that supports HDMI 2.1. The control box also has Wi-Fi and Bluetooth connectivity. In addition to the two HDMI ports, you have an ethernet port, S-Centre out and a USB port just for updates. The system boasts support for DTS-X, Dolby Atmos and Sony's own 360 Reality Audio.

Each of the four speakers has an Up-firing speaker (X-Balanced Speaker Unit), Soft Dome Type Tweeter, Wide Directivity Woofer (X-Balanced Speaker Unit), and Dual microphones. While the Sony HT-A9 is compatible with the SW3 and SW5 subwoofer options. When it comes to smart features, the system supports Amazon Alexa along with Chromecast.

PERFORMANCE

The promise of the Sony HT-A9 is to

offer an immersive surround sound effect without having dedicated speakers placed in the respective sweet spot. Once calibrated, the Sony HT-A9 creates 12 phantom speakers offering users a surround sound experience.

MOVIES

We played a slew of content in 5.1 and Dolby Atmos on the TV and the output is fantastic. In a movie like Ready Player One when the cars jump off the ramp, you can feel the sound move up in the room adding to the Dolby Atmos effect. Same for the Dark Knight Rises when you have Batman whizzing around on his motorcycle. The surround effects are truly immersive.

MUSIC

Just like the HT-A7000, the HT-A9 supports Sony's 360 Reality Audio. With the home theatre, you get quite pronounced bass, deep vocals and very good channel separation.

The music performance is overall very immersive and the channel separation implemented in songs like Bohemian Rhapsody is very pronounced.

VERDICT

The Sony HT-A9 is aimed at those that don't have the dedicated space for a soundbar below their TV or don't have the space to symmetrically place speakers around their room. It provides an immersive experience once calibrated and the system has a lot of low-end grunt so you don't miss the theatre. The only con with the system is the absence of traditional connectivity options like optical and the fact that the speakers are white, so they can get dirty.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

AMPLIFIER TYPE: Digital Amplifier, S-Master HX | AMPLIFIER CHANNELS: 12ch | TOTAL POWER OUTPUT: 504W | SPEAKER STRUCTURE: 4.04ch | CONNECTIVITY: Chromecast built-in, Spotify Connect, Music Service Button, Google Home and Assistant | AUDIO CODECS: SBC, AAC, LDAC | I/O: 1 / 1 (eARC/ARC) | POWER CONSUMPTION: Control Box 15 W / Speaker 22 W

CONTACT

SONY | PHONE: 18001037799 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://www.sony.co.in/>